

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Concise scientific explanation:

- The human nervous system develops from rostral (fore brain) to caudal (hind brain and brain stem), with the rate of growth generally declining as early structures mature .

- Brain development follows a canalization program , making mid line and core structures (hypothalamus , pituitary , thalamus , brain stem) among the first to stabilize after birth . By contrast , the neocortex grows rapidly postnatally , reaching near adult organization in late childhood and adolescence .

- Given this pattern , the most immature and rapidly developing major brain region in newborns is the cortex , especially the prefrontal and temporal cortices of the frontal lobe .

- By contrast , while the cerebellum grows during early childhood , it is often considered somewhat less immature relative to neocortex postnatally compared to many fore brain and brain stem structures .

Therefore , the least developed part of the brain at birth is the cortex , and the correct answer is G .

cortex .

</think>

< answer >

G . cortex

</answer>

